What details should the works section of the application contain? How specific should the applicant be? What level of input is expected of the applicant?

Be specific enough that a reviewer can understand what you are proposing, where it will occur, and how it will be carried out. As per the water sustainability regulations, in addition to the location of the proposed works, the applicant is required to provide a detailed description of the proposed works. In some cases, the proposal is simple and straightforward, in other cases the project and associated works are complex.

It is important to list works so that they are accurately described in the authorization documents. In cases where a project is complex, a site visit with the proponent might be considered to gain a better understanding of the project.

WSA entitles licence holders to undertake several activities in and about a stream in a manner provided in their licence, as well as diverting and using the quantity specified, including the construction, maintenance and operation of works. The decision maker has authority to specify terms and conditions when deciding to issue an authorization.

For example:

Bad: “Install water system improvements.”

Better: “Install one screened intake, approximately 30 m of buried pipe, and a pump connection to supply irrigation water from the creek to the field.”

We need to know the major works and not the minor bits. For example, you have a greenhouse. We need to know how you get the water from the point of diversion to the greenhouse and then that you have a sprinkler system in the greenhouse, but we wouldn’t need to know how many sprinkler heads you have.